

## JOHNBORASBIGREDGROUPEDIT

Travel Radio Australia, and our guest this month is from the Big Red Group, it's John Boris. And John, welcome to the program. Thank you for having me Geoffrey, appreciate it.

Now Big Red Group is a fantastic conglomerate really, you're based in Sydney in Australia and you have stacks of customers. Tell us about Big Red Group, what's it all about? Sure, thanks for that intro. So Big Red Group is a combination of brands, so we have four consumer brands.

We have Red Balloon which is celebrating its 25th anniversary, really exciting, and we're the leader in experiential gifting. We actually created the category here. Adrenaline, which is our activity brand, which is all things driving, flying, diving that gets your heart pumping.

Experience Oz, which has our traditional experience OTA. And then we have Everything New Zealand. And then from our B2B side, we have something called Local Agent, where we work with 1,500 hotel concierge and partners around the country and throughout New Zealand to really bring our portfolio of products to them.

And then of course we have our international inbound business. So lots of different touch points on the consumer side and on B2B. Well it's a tremendous range of things that you covered.

Let's try the adrenaline one. Give us an example of a couple of the companies you have on board. Sure, so we have across our portfolio, we have the biggest experience network in all of Australia and New Zealand.

We have 13,500 experiences, of which about 10% of them are exclusive to us. Another about 10% are uniquely differentiated. So on Adrenaline, for example, if you want to go V8 race car driving or drive supercars, that is one of our best-selling products.

You can come. We are the place to get it. We're the only place to get it aside from going directly, and that is a huge seller for us.

As well as, you know, we do a lot of skydiving on Adrenaline. To me, my favorite, I shouldn't say favorite, that's not, I can't say favorite. One of our best sellers perennially is our race car driving.

It really is fantastic. Well, I suppose that's in all sorts of great racetracks around Australia. A place like Bathurst, I suppose, you have connections in there.

We have racetracks in Sydney, we have racetracks outside of Melbourne. The dates, you can go on [adrenaline.com.au](http://adrenaline.com.au) and find out what's available on what day. Do you have some throughout the country that we can really try to capture that wide audience? Tell me about the concierges.

How do you work with the concierges in Australia and New Zealand? Great question. We have, as I mentioned before, about 1,500 local agents around the country, and it could be anything from

the concierge desk, where they use our local agent platform. So if you queue up there and say, hey, I'd like to know what I can do today, or it could even be, I'm in the Gold Coast, but it's raining, so the plans I had to go on a tour are null and void.

What can I do? They can book you on our platform right then and there. And then we also have platforms, they can access our platform through QR codes, and that could be through a partner, it could be through your hotel room where you might be on a refrigerator magnet, and you can access that in a white label fashion anytime you want. It's really, it's very convenient.

And what's your background, John? How did you get involved with the Big Red Group? I have been scaling tech-enabled companies for a long time, primarily out of the States in global roles. I came to Australia five years ago for ten months, and five years later I'm still here with my family, and so it's great. So I've worked at places such as Lonely Planet, I was MD of Lonely Planet, I've worked at Zagat Survey, Restaurant Guide, I was CEO of a company called If Only, which was an experiential marketplace, and I was chief growth officer for TripAdvisor.

All of that culminated with me becoming president and CGO of Big Red Group. So I love travel, I think it's the way that people experience the world, it broadens their horizons, and at the heart of travel today is experiences. It's the things you do that drive where you go and what you remember about those trips.

Could you give us three of your personal favorite things to do in Australia and New Zealand that you have personally experienced? First of all, I just love Australia and New Zealand. One was I took my family to Uluru. Really had an unbelievable time, it's a pretty magical experience.

You know, some people use the term spiritual there. It was truly amazing, and we did Field of Lights, and it was just an outstanding experience having dinner in the red dirt, and it was just unbelievable. So that's one I recommend to everybody if you have the time and ability to do so.

Second one, we went to Queenstown for the first time. I went there for business and said, oh my gosh, I need to bring my family back, and we had an amazing time. We went skiing last year, and Queenstown is just, it's like something from a different era.

It's just an absolutely beautiful, pristine place, and it just really kind of blew my mind. And then a third one I'd say is, I love, I just love urban exploring too. So, you know, if we go as a family, go to Melbourne, we'll walk the laneways, we'll do all of that.

We live in Sydney, but there's still so much of the Sydney area that we still love to explore, right? Even just going to the Opera House. I take, I always joke, I take the ferry to work every day, and I could not think of a more spectacular commute to work. So there's still so much in our backyard that we always get excited about exploring.

John Boris, it's been wonderful to have you on the program on Travel Radio Australia from the

Big Red Group. How can people find you online? Big Red Group is our corporate name, but you can go to our consumer website, so [redballoon.com.au](http://redballoon.com.au), [adrenaline.com.au](http://adrenaline.com.au), and [experiencehaus.com.au](http://experiencehaus.com.au), and everything New Zealand. So that's how you find us, and if you want to have an amazing experience in Australia and New Zealand, we're the place to go.

Thank you so much. Thank you, appreciate it.